

WOW!

Today, almost everyone carries their own high-tech digital recorder around with them contained in their smartphone.

MULTITRACK RECORDING

Although multitrack recording technology had been around since the end of World War II in the 1940s, it was the American musician Les Paul who pioneered its use for music in the 1950s. He realized that by using many recording heads on a single wide magnetic tape, he could record each musician separately as they played together. His invention gave record producers much greater control over the sound of the finished piece of music.



Multitrack recorder, 1970s

DIGITAL RECORDING

After the late 1970s, tape recording began to be replaced by digital recording. This technology converts sound that has been recorded as electrical signals into a digital code, which can then be converted back into a reproduction of the sound.

The idea was first suggested by the British scientist Alec Reeves back in 1937.

MAGNETIC TAPE

In 1928, the German-Austrian engineer Fritz Pfleumer found a way to record sound onto tape coated with magnetized iron oxide powder. The magnetic particles stored sounds as patterns. Based on Pfleumer's invention, the first tape recorders were produced in the 1930s.



Tape recorder, 1962

Plastic magnetic tape

► HOME RECORDING

Technology is now so advanced that music lovers can make their own high-quality multitrack recordings on everyday devices, such as smartphones and iPads.

